The Scientist and the Bumble Bee

by Harry Baker

INTRODUCTION

They say if something is proven, it must be true. That numbers don't lie. But what if believing those numbers is the very thing that holds us back? For example, according to science, bumble bees shouldn't be able to fly. And yet they do.

This poem is for anyone who's ever been told "you can't" and chose not to listen.

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(10th Poem in the collection, no page number available)

The scientist said the bumblebee couldn't fly,
She lacked the wingbeats per minute or the necessary size,
But the bumblebee in her ignorance proved him wrong,
She knew she could fly cause she'd flown all along
Imagine if she'd listened to the man she might have stopped,
Given up on the spot, tucked her wings in and dropped,
So don't ever let someone tell you what you can't do,

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Just because its proven, doesn't mean it's true.

The bumblebee bumbled, loving her life, she hums as she flies,
The bumblebee fumbled, clumsily stumbled from flower to flower
The bumblebee tumbled, tore through the sky pulling corkscrews and dives,
The bumblebee mumbled, crumbled in front of the queen and her power,
The bumblebee grumbled something explicit, discovered she'd been labelled a gimmick,
The bumblebee rumbled, desperate to eat that nectar so sweet,
The bumblebee humbled her critics, silenced all things scientific,
The bumblebee jumbled her speech, she didn't care cause in the air she was free...

Because she was a busy bee, loved to fly to flowers and visit trees,
Deliver seeds, efficiently, more so than in a breeze,
Intricate and intimate, meticulous, auxiliary,

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And gathered more honey than any sick MCS,
Ever since she learned to fly, she earned her stripes,
Despite the words of hype from learned types,
Suppressed the urge to fight or turn and hide,
Instead she yearned for skies and birds up high,
Her confidence was soaring, She saw scientists as boring,
The sort of people she should be ignoring,
Because they made no sense, at least no scent as sweet as pollen,
Even centimetres from her they depended on their drawings,
And they'd rather follow their charts than follow their hearts,
If they saw a bee leave they would still believe their graphs,
They preferred facts and figures to beeswax and vigour
But she begged to differ as she flew past and laughed,

Meet the scientist, his aim in life was to try and dismiss,
Any hypothesis he deemed preposterous,
When asked why he never swallowed his pride he replied
"that's obvious, it wouldn't fit down my esophagus,"
Not quite the optimist, more like the opposite,

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Less likely to be living in a bubble than popping it,
He had hay fever Pollinosis when close to the anomalous,
Taking measurements, making experiments, accumulating evidence,
His brain contained considerable cleverness compared to his intelligence,
So busy with bees in the room, he forgot the elephant,
His full proof was foolproof except for the truth,
If the bumblebee had read his report she'd have agreed,
she was too heavy therefore would never be airborne,
but ignorance is bliss and that begins with a Bee

This one's for the bees in the hives living lives of aviation,
The ones who survive and help survive through pollination,
The ones who thrive in the sticky situations
With the floccinaucinihilipilification,
Doing what they're doing for the buzz, not for love or money,
Moving and maneuvering above, if the weather's sunny,
Proving to the humans their conclusions are confusing
And unusually refusing to budge,

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This is for those who are being themselves, and who
believe in themselves,
Who see the bee in themselves, and set it free in
themselves,
Who know that even though it's difficult, life is full of
miracles,
And true happiness never came from being cynical,
The bumblebees, forever looking for something sweet,
Overcoming tumbleweeds by holding on the something
sweet,
In summary, this is for those who stay summery,
For there will be bees to come, whatever comes to be.

SOURCE INFORMATION

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